THE DAILY BRIEF

JULY 22, 2026

AI & TECH

Artificial intelligence, models, and emerging technology

Glow Emerges From Stealth at a $1.2 Billion Valuation, Targeting AI-Era Endpoint Security. The cybersecurity landscape is being rewritten by a new class of threats: AI agents, developer tools, and machine identities moving across enterprise endpoints faster than traditional defenses can track. Glow arrived this week with a $1.2B valuation and a blunt message — the old playbook of signatures and sandboxes doesn't work when your adversary is an LLM that can reason its way around your controls. The company is targeting the intersection of AI adoption and expanded attack surface, a space that traditional endpoint vendors have been slow to acknowledge. (TechCrunch)

Anthropic's $1.5 Billion Copyright Settlement Wins Court Approval; Only 350 Authors Opted Out. A federal judge gave final approval to Anthropic's landmark $1.5B settlement with authors who claimed the company trained its models on copyrighted works without permission. The number that stands out: just 350 authors chose to opt out of the settlement class, meaning the vast majority of claimants — and their lawyers — decided this was the best available path to compensation. Anthropic's last-minute legal maneuvers to block opt-outs will fuel ongoing debate about whether landmark AI copyright cases are being resolved fairly or simply being settled into silence. (Ars Technica)

Synthesia Expands Beyond AI Video into Live Coaching Sessions. The AI video platform best known for generating corporate training videos announced a significant pivot this week: AI Roleplay Sessions, an interactive product where employees practice real workplace situations — difficult conversations, sales calls, compliance scenarios — with an AI that responds in real time. The move positions Synthesia squarely against traditional executive coaching firms and LMS platforms that have long dominated enterprise soft-skills training. The pricing model (per-session rather than per-seat) could make high-frequency practice accessible to frontline workers who never had access to a $500/hour executive coach. (TechCrunch)

The Weekend Rumor That Has AI Twitter Choosing Sides: Anthropic and Physical Intelligence in Talks. Two of AI's most ambitious companies — Anthropic and Physical Intelligence — are reportedly in acquisition discussions, according to multiple sources close to the matter. Physical Intelligence, the company behind the popular Pi agent framework and a growing suite of physical AI products, would give Anthropic a significant leg up in the race to build AI that can interact with the real world. For Anthropic, which has been on an aggressive acquisition spree, it would be the largest deal in its history. Neither company has confirmed. (TechCrunch)

Dimension Capital Closes $800 Million Third Fund, Betting on the Science-and-Compute Intersection. The four-year-old venture firm closed its third fund at $800M — 60% larger than Fund II, which itself was announced just 18 months ago. Dimension's thesis is precise: the next wave of AI value will flow not from models themselves but from the companies that figure out how to apply compute at scale to hard scientific problems — drug discovery, materials science, energy. The fund size places Dimension in the upper tier of AI-focused VCs, alongside a16z and Sequoia. (TechCrunch)

MARKETS & FINANCE

Stock markets, crypto, economic indicators, and trading

Zilliqa Halts Native Transactions After Critical Bug Found in Ledger App Dating Back to 2019. The blockchain project disclosed a vulnerability in its official Ledger application that has existed since 2019 — one that could have exposed private keys under certain conditions. Zilliqa's decision to halt all native transactions is precautionary but significant: it means users cannot move funds until a patch is deployed and verified. The incident is a reminder that hardware wallet integrations are often written once and audited infrequently, while the ecosystems around them continue to evolve. For crypto holders who assumed Ledger's security reputation was foolproof, this is a uncomfortable data point. (The Block)

BIS Warns That USD Stablecoins Can Evade Capital Controls, Challenging Traditional Regulatory Assumptions. The Bank for International Settlements — the central bank for the world's central banks — published research this week concluding that stablecoins denominated in US dollars are significantly more effective at circumventing capital controls than traditional foreign exchange mechanisms. The finding has direct policy implications: countries like China, India, and parts of Latin America that use FX restrictions to manage capital flow could find those restrictions meaningless against dollar-backed stablecoins. The BIS is calling for international coordination on stablecoin regulation before the problem becomes intractable. (The Block)

US Seeks Forfeiture of $25 Million in Crypto Linked to Global Fraud Investigations. Federal prosecutors filed forfeiture actions against $25 million in cryptocurrency recovered across five separate international fraud investigations. The cases span romance scams, business email compromise schemes, and at least one nation-state-linked heist. The amounts involved are a fraction of the billions lost to crypto fraud annually, but the coordinated multi-agency approach signals that US authorities are getting better at following the money through mixers, cross-chain bridges, and privacy coins. Chainalysis and TRM Labs have been central to the forensic work. (The Block)

HTX Exchange Allegedly Rotating Wallets to Evade UK Sanctions Screening. HTX, the crypto exchange that was sanctioned by UK authorities in May for its alleged role in facilitating Russian sanctions evasion, has been observed rotating wallet addresses at a high frequency — a technique that makes automated sanctions screening significantly harder to implement reliably. TRM Labs, which first flagged the behavior, noted that the pattern suggests a deliberate attempt to stay one step ahead of compliance systems that rely on static wallet blacklists. The UK has given HTX no public indication of a path to delisting. (The Block)

BRIEFLY

‹ **Meta's AI Bedtime Story App** is being tested internally, letting users describe a story scenario and receive a fully narrated, AI-generated tale. The feature appears targeted at parents who find themselves too depleted to improvise — which is to say, all of them. (TechCrunch)

‹ **WhatsApp Adds Apple CarPlay and Android Auto Support**, allowing drivers to hear and reply to messages hands-free. The update brings it roughly on par with iMessage's CarPlay integration, which has been available since iOS 16. (TechCrunch)

‹ **Countries Moving to Ban Social Media for Minors:** Australia led the way in late 2025; a wave of European and Asian nations are now following with their own legislation, citing youth mental health as the primary driver. (TechCrunch)

‹ **Passionfroot Raises $15M Series A** to expand its B2B creator marketplace connecting brands with independent creators. The German startup is now eyeing the US market, where creator economy infrastructure remains fragmented. (TechCrunch)

THE TAKEAWAY

The thread connecting this Wednesday's most important stories is control: who has it, who wants it, and who's finding new ways around it. Anthropic's $1.5B settlement is a capitulation by an AI company that copied first and negotiated later — but the tiny opt-out rate suggests the legal system is not a reliable guardian of creative rights at scale. Meanwhile, the BIS paper on stablecoins reveals that financial controls built for the SWIFT era are quietly becoming irrelevant, and no amount of capital control legislation will catch a dollar-pegged token moving across a public blockchain. And in endpoint security, Glow's $1.2B valuation tells you that every company rushing to adopt AI agents is simultaneously expanding the attack surface that defenders have to cover. The winners in this environment won't be the ones who move fastest — they'll be the ones who figure out how to move safely.

Generated by Marvin